1.4.1 Location

Every point on the earth has a location. The location can be described in two different ways:

- *Absolute location* is a location as described by its latitude and longitude on the earth. For example, the coordinates of (Chennai Central Railway station) puratchi thalaivar Dr. M.G. Ramachandran Centeral raiway station Railway station are 13°04'56" N latitude and 80°16'32" E longitude.
- *Relative location* is the position of a place in relation to another well-known landmark. For example, Kallanai Dam or Grand Anicut is located roughly 350 km south –southwest of Chennai City. The absolute and relative location related surveys and studies fall under this category.

1.4.2 Place

A place is an area that is defined by everything in it. All places have features that give them personality to distinguish them from other places. A number of place names in Tamil Nadu, like St. Thomas Mount, Fort St. George, Mint, and George Town are examples to this theme.

Student Activity

1. Find the absolute location of your district.
2. Find the important towns within a radius of 100 km from your residence or school along with their direction.
3. Find how the name of your village or town came into existence.
4. Find the total population of your town or village as per 2011 census.
5. Find the altitude of your village or town from Mean Sea Level.

- Toponym: A place name, especially one derived from topographical feature.
- Site: An area of ground on which a town, building, or monument is constructed.
- Situation: The location and surroundings of a place.

1.4.3 Human-Environment Interaction

The theme describes how people interact with the environment and how the environment responds. This is studied with reference to the following three key concepts:

- Dependency: How humans depend on the environment (Example: For water, fresh air, sunlight etc.)
- Adaptation: How humans adapt to the environment (Example: Life in polar and desert regions)
- Modification: How humans modify the environment (Example: Construction of Underground Metro rail, Agriculture in Israel).

1.4.4 Movement

Movement is the network of travel of people, goods and ideas from one location to another. Examples: Rural-urban migration and metro train commuting in Chennai. **Air transport** which carries people and goods and the **internet** that allows access to ideas and knowledge across the world are also examples of this kind.

1.4.5 Region

Regions are areas with distinct homogenous characteristics such as climate (Monsoon regions), natural vegetation (Tropical rain forests), crops (Corn Belt of USA), major landforms (Himalayan region), industries (Bangalore and Hosur) etc.

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